

Meghan Esson

ACADEMIC



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE*Signature: one copy per deck.*

Requires a Health funding source.

Halve your loss from Regulation clauses (round down).

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 4 of your loss from its Mortality or Health Price clauses.*Knows what an ambulance ride costs, who pays for it, and why the answer changes at 65.**Aegon Transamerica RMI Fellow and Assistant Professor of Finance at the University of Iowa. Fellow of the Vaughan Institute of Risk Management. Ph.D. in Economics, University of Georgia.*

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 203 / 379

Hartford

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Health or Assumed Reinsurance funding sources you control, rounded down.

Sells the health plan locally and shares the risk with the whole world.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 359 / 379

Group Health

HEALTH



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

*Staple: any number per deck.***If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.***One employer, thousands of employees, and a deductible nobody understands.*

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 014 / 379

Group Health

HEALTH



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

*Staple: any number per deck.***If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.***One employer, thousands of employees, and a deductible nobody understands.*

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 014 / 379

Group Health

HEALTH



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

*Staple: any number per deck.***If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.***One employer, thousands of employees, and a deductible nobody understands.*

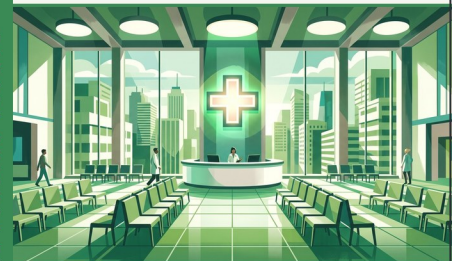
H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 014 / 379

Group Health

HEALTH



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

*Staple: any number per deck.***If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.***One employer, thousands of employees, and a deductible nobody understands.*

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 014 / 379

Individual Health

HEALTH



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.*Covers the cost of medical care. Some of it. After the deductible. In network.*

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 015 / 379

Pet Insurance

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Inflation

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

The claims are small, but the photos attached to them are adorable.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 031 / 379

Pet Insurance

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Inflation

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

The claims are small, but the photos attached to them are adorable.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 031 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Value-Based Care

HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Regulation

Mortality

Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Cheaper care, better outcomes, and a spreadsheet proving both.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 016 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Value-Based Care

HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Regulation

Mortality

Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Cheaper care, better outcomes, and a spreadsheet proving both.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 016 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Value-Based Care

HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Regulation

Mortality

Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Cheaper care, better outcomes, and a spreadsheet proving both.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 016 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Long-Term Care

HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Longevity

Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Pays for nursing homes and home care, priced assuming customers would lapse, and they didn't.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 013 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Long-Term Care

HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Longevity

Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Pays for nursing homes and home care, priced assuming customers would lapse, and they didn't.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 013 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Long-Term Care

HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Longevity

Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Pays for nursing homes and home care, priced assuming customers would lapse, and they didn't.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 013 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pharmacy Benefit Management

HEALTH · SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Health Price

Regulation

Litigation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

The formulary is a maze, and you own the walls.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 017 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pharmacy Benefit Management

HEALTH · SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Health Price

Regulation

Litigation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

The formulary is a maze, and you own the walls.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 017 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Life & Health Combo

LIFE · HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

Low Interest Rates

Regulation

Health Price

Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Life and health coverage in one benefits portal nobody remembers the password to.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 006 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Life & Health Combo

LIFE · HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

▲ Health Price

▲ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Life and health coverage in one benefits portal nobody remembers the password to.

L

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 006 / 379

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Pharmacy Chain

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

COST

3

YIELD

2

each turn

SALE

2

any time

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

▼ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Destroyed if a Litigation Stress Test hits you.

You own the stop where the health trend turns into revenue.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 060 / 379

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Hospital System

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

COST

2

YIELD

1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

SIGNATURE

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Everyone needs care, though not everyone pays for it on time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 061 / 379

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID

COST

3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 054 / 379

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Compliance Software Vendor

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

COST

3

YIELD

2

each turn

SALE

2

any time

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Regulation

▼ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Regulation Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

Destroyed if a Cyber Stress Test hits you.

Regulatory burden, but make it SaaS.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 071 / 379

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Medical Trend Corridor

TREATY

COST

2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Health funding source.

Halve your loss from Health Price clauses (round down).

The claims trend is still bad, but at least it has guardrails.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 119 / 379

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Industry Lobbying

RESPONSE

COST

3

SIGNATURE

RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you.

The trade association would like to submit four hundred pages of comments.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 130 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

Crisis Communications

RESPONSE

COST

2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Reputation Stress Test that hits you.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said the statement drafted in advance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 131 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

Crisis Communications

RESPONSE

COST

2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Reputation Stress Test that hits you.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said the statement drafted in advance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 131 / 379

Quota Share Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 114 / 379

Quota Share Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 114 / 379

Cat Bond Sponsorship: Mortality

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Life or Health funding source.

When Mortality clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Capital-markets investors take the pandemic tail, for a price.

L
H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 125 / 379

Compliance Patsy

RISK & COMPLIANCE

DARK



HIRE

◆ 1

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Regulation or Litigation clauses. Then fire this employee.

Signed everything, read nothing, and is available to start immediately.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 217 / 379

Network Contracting VP

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 5

Requires a Health funding source.

Your Health funding sources have +1 Margin.

Negotiates hospital rates the way other people negotiate hostage releases.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 185 / 379

Risk Management Professor

ACADEMIC



HIRE

◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for a Risk Management card, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

Wrote the textbook your CRO still keeps on the desk.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 213 / 379

Utilization Review Lead

RISK & COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

Requires a Health funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Health Price clauses.

Asks whether the procedure is necessary, then asks again in writing.

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 187 / 379

Utilization Review Lead

RISK & COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

Requires a Health funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Health Price clauses.

Asks whether the procedure is necessary, then asks again in writing.

H

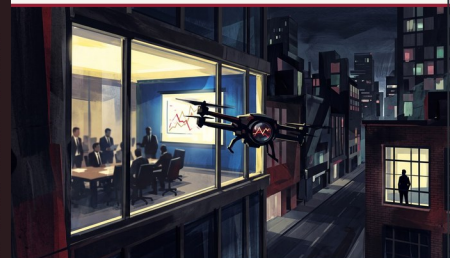
ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 187 / 379

Corporate Espionage

CORPORATE

DARK



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Target opponent refills to 2 fewer cards on their next turn.

The new intern asks a lot of questions about the pricing model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 298 / 379

Consent Decree

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile and 2 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more. Then they have one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

No admission of wrongdoing, just a very large check and a new board.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 303 / 379

Data Breach

CYBER



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Cyber

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Cyber exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 4 more. Then they discard a card.

The password was 'Password1', and the regulator's fine was somewhat harder to guess.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 281 / 379

Counterparty Default

MARKET



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Credit

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Credit exposure and 2 per Risk Management card they control, plus 4 more. Then they discard a Risk Management card of their choice.

Your reinsurer's new mailing address is a law firm.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 242 / 379

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 279 / 379

Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4

branch only

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

The flag is a big plus!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 357 / 379

License Suspension

REGULATION



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one funding source to discard, chosen by the runner.

The letter was two paragraphs long, and the second paragraph was the one about ceasing to write new business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 337 / 379

Cancer Cured

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

Champagne in the lab, followed by a very quiet meeting in annuity reserving.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 250 / 379

Roundup Verdict

LITIGATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2018



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

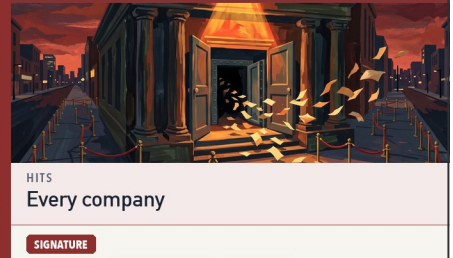
In August 2018, a San Francisco jury ordered Monsanto to pay \$289 million to a groundskeeper who blamed its weedkiller, Roundup, for his cancer.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 286 / 379

Northern Rock Bank Run

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then each company discards half its Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

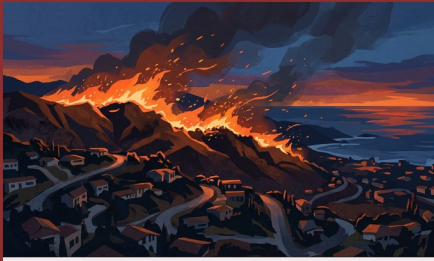
After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 272 / 379

Palisades Fire

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2025



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Nat Cat: Wildfire ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Wildfire exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

Influencers blamed for hot takes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 258 / 379

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 253 / 379

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 237 / 379

Great Recession

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2008



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD** **DEVELOPING EVENT**

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Property Value ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Liquidity

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: all stages this round, each with a response window.

Stage 1. Every company loses 8 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Property Value exposure, 4 per Credit exposure, and 4 per Volatility exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure and 4 per Low Interest Rates exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure. Then each company fires its cheapest employee unless it pays 2 Surplus. After Stage 1 losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds or Mortgage-Backed Securities it controls.

In 2008 the bursting of a U.S. housing bubble set off the worst financial crisis and recession since the 1930s. First the housing market, then the banks, then everyone's job.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 252 / 379

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 379

1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Rising Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 265 / 379

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 305 / 379

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 379

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 288 / 379

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 343 / 379

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 260 / 379

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 309 / 379

Great Bond Massacre

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1994



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure and 3 per Volatility exposure.

On February 4, 1994, the Federal Reserve raised rates by surprise and kept raising them all year, and bond prices fell around the world. Orange County found out in December.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 306 / 379